

Doc 1: Project Overview

1. Elevator Pitch

Terminal United is a casual, social MMORPG built entirely for the modern command line. Heavily inspired by the social hubs of "Tower Unite" and the aesthetic of "Silicon Valley," it serves as a low-stakes, high-vibe terminal hangout. It is specifically designed for developers and engineers to idle, chat, and play mini-games directly in their terminal while waiting for long-running builds or AI agents to complete tasks.

2. Target Audience & Platform

- > **Audience:** Developers, DevOps engineers, and AI supervisors who live in the terminal and want a frictionless, multiplayer third space.
- > **Platform:** Modern terminal emulators. The game leverages advanced terminal protocols (Sixel/Kitty) for inline image rendering and Unicode Braille/Sextant grids for sub-character resolution graphics.

3. Core Mechanics & Gameplay Loop

- > **The Hub:** Players load into a centralized, persistent "Silicon Valley" style map featuring plazas, casinos, clubhouses, and dungeon portals.
- > **Movement & Interaction:** Fast, responsive WASD movement. Players interact with objects (e.g., arcade cabinets, blackjack tables) or walk into map transition zones.
- > **Social Real-Time:** Seamless state synchronization. Players see others moving instantly and can communicate via a global or proximity-based CLI chat sidebar.
- > **Modularity:** The game operates on an instanced "Room" model. Players dynamically disconnect from the Hub and connect to isolated instances for mini-games or combat.

4. Economy, Social & Dungeons

- > **In-Game Economy:** Players earn virtual currency ("Credits" or "Bits") actively or passively. Currency is spent on functional items or cosmetic terminal flairs.

- > **The Casino & Arcades:** Dedicated interactive rooms where players wager currency on classic games (Blackjack, Roulette) or play terminal arcade games.
- > **The Clubhouse (BBS):** A physical in-game building acting as an asynchronous message board, paying homage to classic 90s Bulletin Board Systems.
- > **PvE Dungeons:** Instanced combat zones where players team up or venture solo to fight AI enemies and farm loot.

5. Monetization Strategy

- > **Diegetic Advertising:** Using Sixel/Kitty image protocols, actual digital billboards render `.png` sponsor banners natively in the terminal map.
- > **Sponsored Events:** Global chat broadcast sponsorships integrated without paywalling the core game.